

Best Practices for ERP Customisation and Configuration

To ensure a successful ERP customisation and configuration process, organisations and consulting teams should follow these best practices:



Thorough Requirements Gathering

Conduct comprehensive requirements-gathering sessions to understand the organisation's business processes, pain points, and unique needs. This will help identify areas where customisation or configuration is required and ensure the ERP system is tailored to meet the organisation's specific requirements.



Prioritisation and Phased Implementation

Prioritise customisation and configuration efforts based on business criticality and impact. Implement these changes in a phased approach, first with the most critical requirements. This will help manage risks, ensure timely delivery, and avoid overwhelming the project team or end-users with excessive changes at once.



Testing and User Acceptance

Implement rigorous testing procedures to validate customisations and configurations before deploying them to the production environment. Involve end-users in user acceptance testing to ensure that the customised or configured features meet their expectations and operational requirements.



Change Management and Training

Customisation and configuration often introduce changes to existing processes or user interfaces. Effective change management and comprehensive training are essential to ensure end-users understand and embrace the changes, minimising resistance and maximising adoption of the new or modified features.



Documentation and Knowledge Transfer

Thoroughly document customisations and configurations and the rationale behind them. Ensure that this knowledge is transferred to the organisation's internal teams, enabling them to maintain and support the customised or configured ERP system in the long run.



Upgrade and Maintenance Planning

Develop a strategy for managing future upgrades or version releases of the ERP system. Evaluate the impact of customisations on the upgrade process and plan accordingly to minimise disruptions and ensure a smooth transition to new versions.



Governance and Oversight

Establish a governance framework to manage and oversee customisation and configuration efforts. This framework should include processes for approving, prioritising, and tracking customisation requests and mechanisms for monitoring and controlling the overall level of customisation within the ERP system.

By following these best practices and striking the right balance between customisation, configuration, and standardisation, organisations can effectively tailor their ERP solutions to meet their unique business requirements while minimising risks and ensuring the system's long-term sustainability and maintainability.